



@learnwithbhawana

Ongoing Hackathons to Build Your AI/Tech Portfolio



Points to remember :

You don't need to wait until you feel "job-ready" to start building. A hackathon gives you a deadline, a real problem to solve, and a project you can explain in interviews. It won't guarantee a job, but a working demo, clear README, and lessons from building can strengthen your portfolio.

Important: This list is based on the image you shared, checked against official event pages on **October 8, 2026**. Deadlines, prizes, eligibility, and rules can change. Verify the official page before applying. Prize pools are not guaranteed earnings.

Quick list

Hackathon	Submission deadline	Prize information	Beginner note
AMD Developer Hackathon: ACT III	Oct 18, 2026	The page currently lists \$11,000+ ; the image says \$12,000+	All experience levels; teams of 1–6.
Building with IBM Bob	Oct 18, 2026	\$2,000	Beginner-friendly, but eligibility is limited to US residents.
Amazon Developer Hackathon	Oct 23, 2026	\$138,000 cash	Online; check official rules and choose a product track.
OpenCV AI Competition	Oct 26, 2026	\$20,250 cash	You must use OpenCV 5 and AWS.
AWS CDS Agentic AI Partner Hackathon	Oct 28, 2026	\$40,000 cash	For professionals/postgraduates; AWS Partner requirements apply.
Nebius x NVIDIA Global AI Hackathon	Oct 30, 2026	\$50,000+	Online; build with NVIDIA open models and Nebius services.

1. AMD Developer Hackathon: ACT III :

- What it is: Build an AI or machine-learning project that uses AMD hardware or infrastructure in a meaningful way.
- Who can apply: The event page welcomes participants of all experience levels. Teams can have 1–6 people. You need to register on lablab.ai, join its Discord, and sign up for the AMD AI Developer Program.
- What you could build: An AI agent, an AI-powered workflow, or a practical application that runs on AMD technology.
- Deadline: October 18, 2026, 15:00 UTC. The online build period starts October 12. The in-person event is in Rome; travel and accommodation are not covered.
- Prize note: The current event page lists \$11,000+, while the image lists \$12,000+. Check the prize details on the event page before sharing a prize amount.
- Link to apply : [Official AMD ACT III event page](#)

AMD × Vibe Generation × evolus × LAB LAB × Gemma 4 × Google DeepMind

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WITH THE PARTICIPATION OF PWC ITALIA

AMD DEVELOPER HACKATHON: ACT III

BUILD AI AGENTS AND HIGH-PERFORMANCE AI APPS ON AMD GPUS IN THE CLOUD.

	ONLINE PHASE 12-18 OCTOBER, 2026	ROME, MILAN, IMPERIA; ITALY 17-18 OCTOBER, 2026	PRIZE POOL \$12,000+
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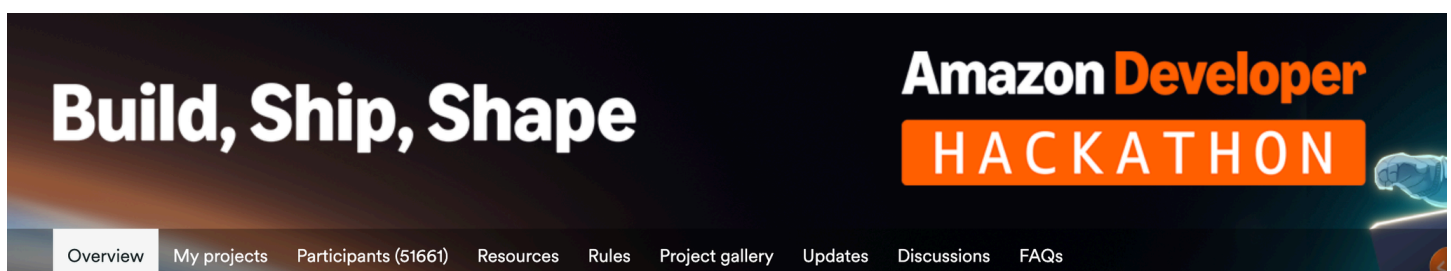
2. Building with IBM Bob :

- What it is: Use IBM Bob, an AI development assistant, to build or improve a software project.
- Who can apply: Participants must be 18 or older and reside in the United States. Teams can have 1-5 members. Developers, designers, product thinkers, and first-time hackers are welcome.
- Beginner track: Understand an unfamiliar app, fix an issue, and add a useful feature. You could also use Bob to explain code, debug, write tests, or document your project.
- Deadline: October 18, 2026, 11:59 p.m. ET.
- Prize: \$2,000 total across the two tracks, plus other listed benefits.
- Link to Apply : [Official IBM Bob hackathon page](#)



3. Build, Ship, Shape: Amazon Developer Hackathon :

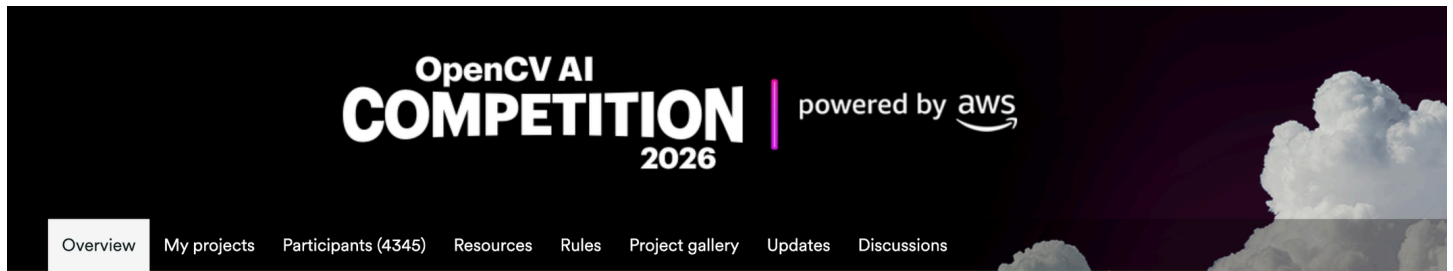
- What it is: Build for Amazon devices and services, including Fire TV, Alexa+, Ring, or Bee. There is also an AWS Builder Mini Challenge.
- Who can apply: The online hackathon is open to people above the legal age of majority in their country, subject to the official rules and country exclusions.
- What you could build: Pick one product track and create a useful app or experience for it. Amazon provides documentation, SDKs, simulators, sample code, and office hours.
- Deadline: October 23, 2026, 12:00 p.m. PDT.
- Prize note: The Devpost page lists \$138,000 in cash prizes. It separately describes a larger combined value that includes AWS credits, so read the track prize details carefully.
- Link to Apply : [Official Amazon Developer Hackathon page](#)



4. OpenCV AI Competition, powered by AWS

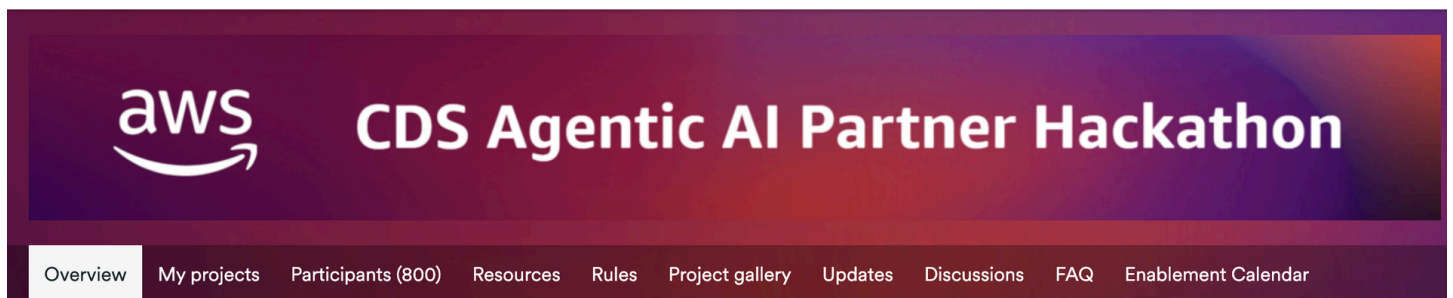
- What it is: Build an application that understands images or video—for example, detecting objects or interpreting what is happening in a scene.
- Who can apply: The online competition is open to participants above the legal age of majority in their country, subject to exclusions in the official rules.
- Required conditions: Every submission must use OpenCV 5 for meaningful image or video analysis and run a meaningful component on AWS. Projects can use any programming language or supporting hardware.
- Deadline: October 26, 2026, 11:59 p.m. Pacific Time.

- Prize note: The Devpost page currently lists \$20,250 in cash. The image's \$12,000 figure may not reflect the current total.
- Link to Apply : [Official OpenCV AI Competition page](#)



5. AWS CDS Agentic AI Partner Hackathon

- What it is: Build an AI-powered customer communication experience using AWS Communication Developer Services, such as messaging over SMS, WhatsApp, or email.
- Who can apply: The page lists participants above the legal age of majority and professionals/postgraduates only. It also includes AWS Partner requirements, including creating an opportunity through AWS Partner Central. Review the full rules to confirm your eligibility before building.
- What you could build: For example, a service assistant that starts a conversation by SMS and helps a customer complete a task through WhatsApp or email.
- Deadline: October 28, 2026, 1:00 p.m. PDT.
- Prize: \$40,000 in cash prizes.
- Link to Apply : [Official AWS CDS hackathon page](#)



6. Nebius x NVIDIA Global AI Hackathon

- What it is: Build an AI application using NVIDIA open-source models, such as Nemotron, with Nebius Token Factory or Nebius AI Cloud.
- Who can apply: The online event is open to participants above the legal age of majority in their country, subject to the official rules and country exclusions.
- What you need to submit: A working project, a public code repository with an open-source license and setup instructions, a working demo or demo URL, and a public YouTube video of up to three minutes.
- **Deadline: October 30, 2026, 10:00 a.m. PDT.**
- Prize: The official page lists \$50,000+ in prizes, including cash and other awards.
- Link to Apply : [Official Nebius x NVIDIA hackathon page](#)

Nebius x NVIDIA Global AI Hackathon

Build the next frontier of AI on open infrastructure

[Overview](#)[My projects](#)[Participants \(19786\)](#)[Resources](#)[Rules](#)[Project gallery](#)[Updates](#)[Discussions](#)[FAQs](#)

How a beginner can use a hackathon to support a job search?

- Choose one problem you can explain simply. Start with a small, useful project rather than a large idea.
- Pick a role for yourself. You could work on Python, the user interface, data, testing, or the presentation.
- Build a working demo. A small project that runs is easier to discuss than an unfinished idea.
- Write a clear README. Explain the problem, what your project does, how to run it, and what you contributed.
- Share what you learned. Add the project to your portfolio and describe your decisions and challenges in interviews.
- Participation does not guarantee a job, a prize, or recruiter attention. The value is the experience and evidence of what you built.

Before you register

- Open the official event page and read the complete rules and FAQs.
- Check country, age, education, employment, and team requirements.
- Confirm the deadline in your own time zone.
- Check whether the project must use a specific tool or platform.
- Confirm what code, demo, video, pitch deck, or README you need to submit.
- Check prize terms, costs, credits, and travel requirements.
- Use only original work and follow the event's rules.